

WASHINGTON

Trump backs Musk’s threat over job lists

Multiple agencies have told workers to ignore emails to detail work or be fired

By **CHRIS MEGERIAN**
and **LINDSAY WHITEHURST**
Associated Press

WASHINGTON — President Donald Trump voiced support for Elon Musk’s demand that federal employees explain their recent accomplishments by the end of Monday or risk getting fired, an edict that has spawned new litigation and added to turmoil within the government workforce.

“What he’s doing is saying, ‘Are you actually working?’” Trump said in the Oval Office during a meeting with French President Emmanuel Macron. “And then, if you don’t answer, like, you’re sort of semi-fired or you’re fired, because a lot of people aren’t answering because they don’t even exist.”

The Republican president said that Musk’s Department of Government Efficiency has found “hundreds of billions of dollars in fraud” as he suggested that federal paychecks are going to nonexistent employees. He did not present evidence for his claims.

“If people don’t respond, it’s very possible that there is no such person, or they aren’t working,” Trump said.

Attorneys representing unions, businesses, veterans and conservation organizations filed an updated lawsuit in federal court in California on Monday, arguing Musk had violated the law with his demand. The Office of Personnel Management, which functions as a human resources agency for the federal government,

told employees to detail five things they did last week by the end of Monday.

The lawsuit, spearheaded by the State Democracy Defenders Fund, called the threat of mass firings “one of the most massive employment frauds in the history of this country.”

The White House criticized the litigation.

“In the time it took these employees on taxpayer-funded salaries to file a frivolous lawsuit, they could have briefly recapped their accomplishments to their managers, as is common in the private sector, 100 times over,” said Anna Kelly, a deputy press secretary, in a statement.

Musk is leading Trump’s efforts to overhaul and downsize the federal government, and they’ve already caused upheaval by pushing employees to resign, laying off probationary workers and halting work at some agencies.

However, there are signs Musk is testing the limits of his influence, and some administration officials told employees not to respond to his demand. It has been the most significant public divergence between the billionaire entrepreneur and Senate-approved Cabinet leaders, who have otherwise been enthusiastic about fulfilling Musk’s objectives.

Trump dismissed the idea there was any kind of split involving his most powerful adviser.

“They don’t mean that in any way combatively with



Elon Musk, left, receives a chainsaw from Argentina President Javier Milei as they arrive speaks at the Conservative Political Action Conference at the Gaylord National Resort & Convention Center on Thursday outside Washington.

AP/JOSE LUIS MAGANA

Elon,” he said, adding that “everyone thought it was a pretty ingenious idea.”

The Office of Personnel Management declined to comment on Monday as Musk continued to threaten federal workers with layoffs despite the confusion.

“Those who do not take this email seriously will soon be furthering their career elsewhere,” he posted on X, his social media platform.

The latest turbulence began over the weekend, when Trump posted on his social media website: “ELON IS DOING A GREAT JOB, BUT I WOULD LIKE TO SEE HIM GET MORE AGGRESSIVE.”

Musk followed by saying “all federal employees will

shortly receive an email requesting to understand what they got done last week.” He claimed “failure to respond will be taken as a resignation.” The directive echoed how the entrepreneur has managed his own companies.

The Office of Personnel Management sent out its own request afterward.

“Please reply to this email with approx. 5 bullets of what you accomplished last week and cc your manager,” the message said. However, it said nothing about the potential for employees being fired for noncompliance. The deadline was listed as 11:59 p.m. EST Monday.

There was swift resistance

from several key U.S. agencies led by the president’s loyalists — including the FBI, the State Department, Homeland Security and the Pentagon — which instructed their employees over the weekend not to respond. Lawmakers in both major political parties said Musk’s mandate may be illegal.

Justice Department employees were told in an email Monday morning that they don’t need to respond to the request “due to the confidential and sensitive nature of the Department’s work.”

But employees in the U.S. attorney’s office in Washington were instructed to respond “in general terms,”

leaving out case-specific or otherwise sensitive information. In an email viewed by The Associated Press, attorneys were provided with guidance about how to respond about the number of court hearings they attended, defendants they charged, cases they resolved or other tasks.

One message Sunday morning from the Department of Health and Human Services, led by Robert F. Kennedy Jr., instructed its 80,000 employees to comply. That was shortly after the acting general counsel, Sean Keveney, had instructed some not to. And by Sunday evening, agency leadership issued new instructions that employees should “pause activities” related to the request until noon Monday.

“Having put in over 70 hours of work last week advancing Administration’s priorities, I was personally insulted to receive the below email,” Keveney said in an email that acknowledged a broad sense of “uncertainty and stress” within the agency.

Keveney laid out security concerns and pointed out some of the work done by the agency’s employees may be protected by attorney-client privilege.

Education Department workers were directed to comply on Monday morning. “The email is legitimate and employees should respond,” wrote Rachel Oglesby, chief of staff at the department.

FBI Director Kash Patel, an outspoken Trump ally who was recently confirmed by the Senate, instructed employees to ignore Musk’s request, at least for now.

LEGAL NOTICES

Legals

Legal Notice

The Town of Amherst is inviting sealed bids for water and sewer chemicals. Invitations for Bids may be obtained by visiting www.amherstma.gov/bids.

Bids shall be submitted no later than 2:00PM on March 12, 2025 to the Town of Amherst's Accountant's Office where the bids will be publicly opened and recorded.

The Town of Amherst reserves the right to reject any and all bids in whole or in part, and to waive minor informalities, when at its sole discretion is deemed to be in the best interests of the Town and to the extent permitted by law.

February 25

4443208

Legals

TOWN OF SOUTHAMPTON NOTICE OF PLANNING BOARD PUBLIC HEARING Relative to Proposed Zoning Bylaw Amendments regarding Solar Electric Generating Facilities, Site Plan Review, and Accessory Dwelling Units

Pursuant to the provisions of M.G.L. Chapter 40A, Section 5, the Southampton Planning Board will hold a public hearing to discuss proposed amendments to the Zoning Bylaw regarding Solar electric generating facilities, Accessory dwelling units, and Site plan review and approval as follows:

a. Amending § 275-23 "Definitions" to delete some terms and add new terms.
b. Deleting § 275-7.5 "Accessory apartments" and inserting its place a new § 275-7.5 "Accessory Dwelling Units".
c. Deleting § 275-7.6 "Solar electric generating facilities" and inserting in its place a new § 275-7.6 "Solar electric generating facilities".
d. Revising Attachment 1 - Table 1 Use Regulations by deleting the use "Accessory apartment" and inserting a new use regarding Accessory Dwelling Unit;
e. Revising Attachment 1 - Table 1 Use Regulations regarding "solar electric generating facilities";
f. Amending § 275 by deleting Article IX "Site Plan Review and Approval" and replace with a new Article IX entitled "Site Plan Review"
g. Amending § 275-3.2.B, § 275-3.9, § 275-7.4.B(1), § 275-7.5.E(i), § 275-7.15.E(i), § 275-7.6.G, and § 275-7.6.H regarding references to "site plan review/approval", "Site Plan review and approval", "Site Plan Review", and "Site Plan Approval"
h. The public hearing shall be held on March 5, 2025 at 7:00 p.m. in the 1st floor meeting room in Town Hall at 210 College Highway, Southampton, MA 01073.

The complete text relative to the proposed amendment to the Zoning Bylaw is available for inspection during regular business hours at Southampton Town Hall - Town Clerk; 210 College Highway Southampton, MA 01073.

Additionally, a copy of said proposed amendments is posted on the Town's website at the Town. Any person interested in, or wishing to be heard on, the proposed Zoning Bylaw amendments/recodification should appear at the time and place designated for the public hearing.

Paul Diemand, Chair

February 18, 25

4443004

Legals

Commonwealth of Massachusetts The Trial Court Probate and Family Court Hampshire Division INFORMAL PROBATE PUBLICATION NOTICE Docket No. HS25P0061EA

Estate of: **Katherine Nancy Rittner**
Also known as: **Katherine N. Rittner**
Date of Death: **October 20, 2024**
To all persons interested in the above captioned estate, by Petition of **Virginia H Rittner of South Hadley, MA**
a Will has been admitted to informal probate.
Virginia H Rittner of South Hadley, MA
has been informally appointed as the Personal Representative of the estate to serve without surety on the bond.
The estate is being administered under informal procedure by the Personal Representative under the Massachusetts Uniform Probate Code without supervision by the Court. Inventory and accounts are not required to be filed with the Court, but interested parties are entitled to notice regarding the administration from the Personal Representative and can petition the Court in any matter relating to the estate, including distribution of assets and expenses of administration. Interested parties are entitled to petition the Court to institute formal proceedings and to obtain orders terminating or restricting the powers of Personal Representatives appointed under informal procedures. A copy of the Petition and Will, if any, can be obtained from the Petitioner.

February 25

4443210

Legals

Commonwealth of Massachusetts The Trial Court Probate and Family Court Hampshire Division INFORMAL PROBATE PUBLICATION NOTICE Docket No. HS25P0100EA

Estate of: **Valerie Matthew**
Date of Death: **October 14, 2024**
To all persons interested in the above captioned estate, by Petition of **Thomas B. Matthew of Southamptn, MA**
Thomas B. Matthew of Southamptn, MA
has been informally appointed as the Personal Representative of the estate to serve without surety on the bond.
The estate is being administered under informal procedure by the Personal Representative under the Massachusetts Uniform Probate Code without supervision by the Court. Inventory and accounts are not required to be filed with the Court, but interested parties are entitled to notice regarding the administration from the Personal Representative and can petition the Court in any matter relating to the estate, including distribution of assets and expenses of administration. Interested parties are entitled to petition the Court to institute formal proceedings and to obtain orders terminating or restricting the powers of Personal Representatives appointed under informal procedures. A copy of the Petition and Will, if any, can be obtained from the Petitioner.

February 25

4443222

Community Connectors

I can connect your business with local, regional and national prospects offering **UNLIMITED** business connections!

I'm Zac Brittain and I'm a Media Consultant with the Daily Hampshire Gazette and NNE, the digital arm of the Gazette and Recorder. Let's talk about how our media group can deliver results for YOU!

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